

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) Red Phalarope

(Scientific Name) *Phalaropus fulicaria*Red 2/19/01 upl
(3 photos)

Date(s) of occurrence: 7/19/00

Number of birds seen: 1

Sex: FEMALE

Plumage: Molting out of alternate

Location: West side of Jumbo Reservoir, Logan County

Length of observation:

Time(s) of observation:

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Joe Fontaine

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): ??

Conditions: Warm, slightly cloudy with late morning light.

Optical equipment used: B & L Elite 10 x 42 binocular.

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 75 – 300 meters

Details:

Joe and I were on our way to go birding in Nebraska. We decided to stop at Jumbo Reservoir to see if there was anything of note. While scanning through a nice mixed flock of ca. 350 shorebirds, Joe Fontaine said that he found a "red shorebird." I was thinking he had found a juvenile Western – or something like that. Then I saw this female Red Phalarope still mostly in alternate plumage and realized he was talking about a RED shorebird!

The bird never fully came out of the water (except in flight). It spent most of its time wading and swimming rapidly, while picking something from the waters surface. The movements were very rapid – even more rapid than Wilson's Phalarope averages.

Identification is straightforward and is clearly illustrated by the three images captured from video I took through my scope (page 2). Note the conspicuous white wingstripe in flight – this is the first time that I had seen this feature in Colorado. The overall pattern is unlike anything else. I suppose Red Warbler (*Ergaticus ruber*) shares the pale gray auriculars on an otherwise mostly red bird, though in that species the patch does not mostly surround the eye!! Honestly, no other species is remotely similar to a Red Phalarope in this plumage.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

This is only my second Red Phalarope for Colorado – I have seen others on the East Coast.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None.

This report is from notes made after observation.

Date of written report: 6 February, 2001

Reporting observer: Christopher L. Wood, zeledonia@att.net

Signature: **Christopher L. Wood (electronic submission)**

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